



PROGRESS REPORT

Zimbabwe: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-01-2 · 289 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY ·
INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	National Development Strategy 2 was launched in December 2025 for 2026 to 2030, and Cabinet names it with three standing instruments as the digital agenda's frame. NDS2 was launched on 8 December 2025 as the successor national plan for 2026 to 2030, presented as the outcome of broad-based national consultations taking in the private sector, faith-based organisations, development partners and the diaspora (launch , strategy). Cabinet's briefing of 14 July 2026 names NDS2, the Smart Zimbabwe 2030 master plan, the National ICT Policy and the National AI Strategy 2026-2030 as the frameworks the digital transformation agenda runs under (briefing). The base holds no single whole-of-government digital transformation strategy. The agenda is carried by four documents of different vintages, two of which state no adoption date of their own (ICT policy , master plan).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The National ICT Policy 2022-2027 states no adoption or publication date anywhere in its text, and a Smart Zimbabwe 2030 master plan carries no publication date, foreword date or gazette reference. The ICT policy is the operative published national instrument, distinct from a still-unpublished 2026-2030 policy named in passing elsewhere; its year is padded from its own title (policy). The master plan builds on a 2016-2020 policy and a continental manifesto, and its year is padded from its own end-2018 baseline data (master plan). Two undated national instruments, both dated here by inference from their own contents, is the documentary base under everything in this unit.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A Postal and Telecommunications (Amendment) Bill is before the Parliamentary Legal Committee, and a local-ownership rule was gazetted and reported repealed within weeks. The bill was gazetted in October 2025 and reached the legal committee in August 2026; the Act it amends constitutes the communications regulator, which is also the designated data protection authority (bill , watch). The ownership rule was gazetted on 12 June 2026 and reported repealed by a later statutory instrument; the repeal is reported and not verified against a primary, and no copy of the repealing instrument is held (rule). A gazetted ownership requirement whose repeal cannot be verified is a live uncertainty for every licensee in the market.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A sovereign national cloud is provided for in a strategy a media rights organisation records as having no legal force, and the operator states its artificial-intelligence compute is hosted abroad. The strategy mandates local storage; a media rights organisation records that it has no legal force, and a proposed act is named as the instrument that would supply residency rules (cloud , implications). The operator's own launch announcement states first-hand that the compute is hosted in a neighbouring country (siting , service , unit). A residency mandate with no legal force, and the country's principal artificial-intelligence service running outside its borders on the provider's own statement, is the sovereignty position the record supports.	MIXED a sovereign cloud and local storage mandated by a strategy with no legal force while the operator's AI compute is sited abroad

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A government enterprise architecture blueprint was handed over in May 2026 and a service bus announced; no interoperability framework document is held. A customised government enterprise-architecture framework, strategy, roadmap and change-management plan was built over September 2023 to September 2024, with representatives of more than 40 ministries, departments and agencies taking part (project). The blueprint was handed over to government ICT directors in May 2026, and the ICT minister put radical interoperability first among five priorities, announcing a government service bus and an integrated online portal for once-only data sharing (handover , priorities). A National Migration Data Strategy 2025-2030 was launched on 15 May 2026 with the migration agency and the statistics agency, a sector data-sharing framework rather than a national one (migration data). No published interoperability framework, data-exchange specification or service-bus procurement is held.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A National AI Strategy 2026-2030 was approved by Cabinet in October 2025 and launched by the President in March 2026, and the strategy text is now held in full. Trade press reported six pillars where the document sets out four strategic pillars inside a six-pillar implementation frame (strategy , launch , penetration , lessons). A National AI Council is named in the strategy as the critical first step and remains planned (council), and an implementation office is provided for in the ICT ministry, funded from the Treasury and the regulator-managed universal service fund (office). The strategy carries its own account of its consultations, closing at a provincial centre in September 2025; that record is the strategy's account of itself (consultations). Every institution the strategy creates is still planned.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	Guideline CDPG 4 bars hosting core banking and critical financial systems outside Zimbabwe without written approval, and enforcement becomes mandatory inspection in September 2026. The data protection authority's implementation guidelines state that it will not permit the migration or hosting of highly sensitive information, such as core banking platforms and critical financial systems, outside Zimbabwe, and that any exception needs prior written approval on a risk assessment and justification (guidelines). Regulatory Notice 2 of 2026 moves compliance from licensing to mandatory risk-based inspections of data controllers from 1 September 2026, beginning with nine priority sectors (inspections). A notice dated 8 March 2026 told organisations processing personal data without a data controller licence to regularise immediately, almost a year after the 12 March 2025 deadline had passed (warning). The guidelines are held as an excerpt truncated at the sixth of seven guidelines, so the full localisation regime is not on file.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A National Data Agency and a national digital regulatory committee are both provided for in the artificial-intelligence strategy, and both remain planned. The data agency is provided for in the strategy approved by Cabinet in October 2025 (agency). The regulatory committee would report to the communications regulator, which is also the designated data protection authority (committee). Creating a data agency and a regulatory committee under a body that already holds both the telecommunications and data-protection mandates is a concentration the strategy proposes and does not address.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	No national open data policy is held. The statistics agency runs an open data portal, and an open government data initiative is announced but not made. The statistics agency's open data portal is in its second version, with an access and tutorial guide published for users and an SDMX rollout behind it (portal). An open government data initiative is announced under the artificial-intelligence strategy as a commons for public institutions, industry and researchers, and remains a plan (initiative). What the base does not hold is a policy: no instrument setting what public bodies must publish, on what licence, or to what timetable. The portal is an operating system without a published rule behind it.	NO CHANGE a portal in operation with no policy behind it
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Cyber and Data Protection Act was consolidated in 2022, and Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 created a data-controller licensing regime a legal expert calls new and strange. The same Act establishes a cyber security centre and inserts a false-data-message offence into the criminal code (Act , overview). The statutory instrument was gazetted in September 2024 with licence applications due six months on; two outlets date the deadline to 12 March 2025 and the gazetted text's own reckoning gives 13 March, and an analyst expects the cost to reach consumers as dearer airtime and data (instrument , warning , fees). Two regulatory notices followed in 2026, neither published by the regulator itself: the first is reported with no signature date held (notice one), and the second sets inspections beginning 1 September 2026 (notice two).	ADVANCED

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Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Cyber and Data Protection Act is unamended, cybercrime offences sit in the Criminal Law Code, and a national cybersecurity strategy was completed in October 2025. The Act of 2021 remains the principal statute, designating the telecommunications regulator as data protection authority and providing for a cyber security centre; it is unamended and administrative sanctions are still not provided for (Act). The regulator's director-general stated on 24 January 2026 that Zimbabwe has no standalone cybercrime Act, and that hacking, unlawful acquisition of data and related offences sit in Part VIII of the Criminal Law (Codification and Reform) Act as amended in 2021, hacking carrying a fine or up to ten years' imprisonment (clarification). The ICT ministry announced on 15 October 2025 that the National Cybersecurity Strategy had been completed, a day after Cabinet approved the artificial-intelligence strategy (strategy). The same minister described a 2026-2030 strategy as still being finalised in July 2026, and no text is held at either date (July 2026).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	No digital-identity Act is held. Identity rests on the National Registration Act, and a 2026 constitutional amendment moved the voters' roll to the registrar-general. The National Registration Act, commenced in 1976 and consolidated to 31 December 2016, is the statute under which the register of residents and the issue of identity documents sit (Act). Constitution of Zimbabwe Amendment (No. 3) Act, Act No. 6 of 2026, amends the Constitution to assign the registrar-general responsibility for voter registration and custody of the voters' roll, consolidating electoral identity under the national identity authority (amendment). The commissioning of the Mutare provincial registry office for biometric passport and identity services was described by the registrar-general as foundational to a digital identity system (registry office). There is no electronic-identity or digital-identity Act, and no legal basis on file for the national digital identity that remains announced and unlaunched.	ADVANCED on a constitutional amendment rather than on any digital-identity statute

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The National Payment Systems Act of 2001 is the standing statute, and Statutory Instrument 65 of 2026 opened a licensed fintech sandbox at the Victoria Falls financial centre. The Act of 2001, commenced on 16 November 2001 and consolidated to 31 December 2016, provides for the recognition, operation, regulation and supervision of payment, clearing and settlement systems, electronic payment instructions included (Act). Statutory Instrument 65 of 2026, made under section 81 of the Banking Act, establishes a technology department and a financial technology lab at the Victoria Falls International Financial Services Centre, with application, licensing, variation, suspension, monitoring and interim and final reporting for tested activities (regulations). The instrument is held as a capture truncated near section 9, so the licensing conditions themselves are not on file.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	No Act enabling data interoperability is held. The Cyber and Data Protection Act governs lawful sharing, and the standards work is technical rather than statutory. The Act's transborder-flow and processing provisions are the strongest enacted instrument bearing on lawful data linking and sharing, and they constrain rather than mandate exchange (Act). Where interoperability is being enabled, it is by technical standard rather than legislation: a national health information exchange is in development to connect laboratory, logistics and facility systems (exchange). Nothing on the base creates a duty on public bodies to make their systems interoperable, or a legal basis for once-only data sharing across ministries.	NO CHANGE the sharing rules sit in data-protection law and no interoperability statute exists

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	A national artificial-intelligence act is proposed by the strategy with no draft on record, and an ethics framework is committed for tabling by the first quarter of 2027. The act is a strategy proposal with no draft on record (act , privacy). The minister's own caveat on the ethics framework was that policy without implementation is mere poetry (framework). A regulatory sandbox is named in the strategy and a supervising council was announced in August 2026 (sandbox), and technical standards are likewise a strategy proposal (standards). Four artificial-intelligence instruments, all proposed by one strategy that has no legal force.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	Cabinet directed drafting of a statutory instrument on e-hailing services, reported to Parliament in August 2026 with no text, consultation or commencement date published. It is a drafting instruction (direction). It is the only platform-economy instrument in this ledger, and the revenue motive named in the reporting is what places it here rather than in transport.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The Census and Statistics Act is in force as consolidated in 2020, and the statistics agency said in October 2025 that it is outdated. The Act, consolidated on 4 September 2020, constitutes the statistics agency and carries its census, survey and data-collection powers (Act). On World Statistics Day 2025 the agency said the Act is outdated and does not adequately support the efficient provision of official statistics, naming uneven connectivity in rural areas as its other operational constraint (statement). The agency adopted a board charter setting the statutory board's roles, authority and ethical standards, and naming the professional independence and credibility of official statistics among what it safeguards (charter). No amendment Bill, formal review or reform timetable is held: the agency's own account of the defect is the whole of the record.	NO CHANGE the controlling Act called outdated by the agency it constitutes

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Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	The Freedom of Information Act is in force, and two 2026 High Court rulings pull in opposite directions on what the section 62 right reaches. The Act of 2020, commenced on 1 July 2020, implements the section 62 constitutional right of access to information and repealed the Access to Information and Protection of Privacy Act (Act). On 24 December 2025 the High Court held that withholding the report of the commission of inquiry into urban state land sales violates section 62 and ordered its publication within 90 days (judgment). On 17 August 2026 the same court dismissed an application to compel a bank to disclose foreign-currency allocation records, holding that banking secrecy under section 76 of the Banking Act barred disclosure without the central bank's authorisation (ruling). Whether the commission report was published inside the 90 days is not held.	MIXED a court ordering publication under the constitutional right while another read a statutory secrecy provision as limiting it
Data protection	Data protection authority	721 data controllers were licensed by October 2025 with no figure since, close to 1,200 officers trained, and certification costs US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee per officer. The licensed-controller count has not moved since October 2025 (licensed institutions), and close to 1,200 officers have been trained (trained). Certification is required of every officer at US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee (certification). Doctors have objected to the levies, the statutory instrument's fee schedule is not held, and no licence count, exemption or regulator response to the objections is on record (objections critique). Mandatory compliance inspections begin on 1 September 2026; the notice sets a start date and no inspection programme, sanction schedule or first action is published (inspections crackdown).	MIXED a licensing and certification regime built out while its fees are objected to as a cost that reaches consumers

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	National data protection readiness	A National Child Online Protection Policy 2026-2030 was approved by Cabinet with the text not held, and the anti-corruption commission set out investigations into cyber-enabled fraud in state digital systems. The policy text is not held, and no reporting route, responder training programme or budget line for it is on record (policy); an earlier policy of the same name was reported established alongside the cybersecurity strategy on the minister's claim, relayed by one outlet (earlier). The fraud figures are the commission chair's, given at a conference; no charge sheet, audit report or system-remediation record is held for any of the three systems (investigations). A privacy responsibility challenge was launched by the regulator, reaching the base at two-month date precision through a recurring round-up (challenge).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	A three-day regional data-governance harmonisation workshop was held in the capital, and a bilateral immigration memorandum carried a benchmarking visit on border technology. No outcome document, commitment or timetable from the workshop is held (workshop). The immigration memorandum was signed in 2024 at year precision, its text not held, and a benchmarking visit followed in July 2026 (memorandum). The border system that visit examined is recorded separately, and its transfer to another state runs on that bilateral memorandum and study visits rather than a continental standard.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	Zimbabwe hosted the SADC cluster ministerial in June 2026 and its regulator was nominated to lead regional data-protection capacity building for 2026. Ministers responsible for transport, ICT, information and meteorology met in Bulawayo on 26 June 2026, where the secretariat reported steady progress in implementing the SADC Digital Transformation Strategy among the region's standing frameworks (ministerial). Southern African regulators, data-protection authorities and the region's own bodies met in August 2026 on harmonising data governance, and the Zimbabwean regulator was nominated by SADC to lead regional data-protection capacity building through 2026 (nomination). The President sat as vice-chairperson of the COMESA Authority at its twenty-fourth summit in October 2025, which commended progress on the COMESA digital retail payment platform and named Zimbabwe as host of the twenty-fifth summit (communique). Zimbabwe's own transborder provisions sit in the Cyber and Data Protection Act; no accession to a continental data-protection convention is held.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Zimbabwe implements two COMESA trade platforms and switched on the first phase of a cross-border fibre corridor in July 2026. COMESA's own account at April 2026 puts Zimbabwe among five member states implementing the electronic certificate of origin launched in November 2024, and among fifteen implementing the electronic single window, which takes trade documentation through one platform rather than several agencies (COMESA). The Plumtree to Bulawayo phase of a Botswana-Zimbabwe-Zambia fibre corridor went live in July 2026, the state fixed operator and its partner reporting 800 Gbps of equipped capacity (corridor). The SADC cluster ministerial Zimbabwe hosted in June 2026 called for improved cross-border connectivity and resilient early-warning systems, without naming a Zimbabwean commitment (ministerial).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A signed guideline governs personal-data transfers out of Zimbabwe, 24 had been authorised by late 2025, and a customs data exchange is agreed with three neighbours. The data protection authority's guideline CDPG 5 of 2024, signed on 13 November 2024 under sections 6(1)(a) and 28(3) of the Cyber and Data Protection Act, is the specific instrument governing transfers of personal information out of the country (guideline). 24 cross-border personal-data transfers had been authorised under the Act by late 2025 (figure). It is the first such count the base holds, so it establishes a level rather than a direction. Revenue authorities from Malawi, Mozambique, Zambia and Zimbabwe renewed a commitment on 27 August 2025 in Lusaka to fast-track an integrated customs-to-customs data exchange, to speed trade and curb illicit cross-border flows (customs). No build, budget or go-live date is held.	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards	An enterprise architecture blueprint was handed over in May 2026 and a civil registration and health platform is in build; no national interoperability standard is published. The enterprise-architecture framework built over 2023 and 2024 was handed to government ICT directors in May 2026, with a government service bus announced for once-only data sharing across ministries (handover , priorities). The registrar-general's ICT deputy told the regional registrars' meeting on 18 July 2026 that a secure platform to exchange birth and death notifications is being implemented, with health systems joined through standardised interfaces and automated validation against the national population register; middleware design is due in the fourth quarter of 2026 and a three-province pilot in the first half of 2027 (presentation). A national health information exchange platform went to formal procurement on 29 May 2026, with bids closing on 22 June (procurement). No published national interoperability standard or data-exchange specification is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National quality standards	The first National Quality Policy has lapsed, and the industry minister said in May 2026 that a replacement framework is in its final stages. The first policy set out the national quality infrastructure, identifying the national standards body and proposing its rebrand and re-legislation (policy). The industry minister said on 8 May 2026 that a replacement National Quality Policy Framework is in its final stages, developed through consultations with industry, academia and regulatory commissions, and that a National Accreditation Board is being established (replacement). The minister dates the first policy's expiry to 2023, where the document the base holds is titled 2021-2025. Neither the replacement framework nor an instrument constituting the accreditation board is held.	ADVANCED a replacement framework still in drafting after the first policy lapsed
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The standards catalogue carries ZWS adoptions of ISO and IEC standards, and the information-security certification scheme was accredited regionally in February 2026. The national standards body's catalogue, updated to March 2025, carries dedicated sections for ZWS adoptions of ISO and of IEC standards, covering information security, software and cloud computing (catalogue). Its ZWS ISO/IEC 27001:2022 information-security certification scheme is accredited by the Southern African Development Community Accreditation Services, alongside quality, environmental, occupational-health and food-safety schemes (accreditation). A financial group announced on 10 June 2026 that its banking, insurance and securities subsidiaries had attained ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification, the base's one dated instance of a Zimbabwean institution certified against the adopted standard (certification). No count of certified organisations is published.	ADVANCED

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Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	The statistics strategy runs standing thematic working groups with non-state members, and civil society published an independent critique of the AI strategy in June 2026. The statistics strategy for 2021-2025 carries an annex of thematic working groups mapped to ministries, departments and agencies, and records that its own formulation involved civil society organisations and United Nations agencies alongside government (strategy). The artificial-intelligence strategy carries its own consultation record, closing at a provincial centre in September 2025 (consultations). At the strategy's launch the United Nations resident coordinator called for independent oversight capacities in government, civil society, academia and professional bodies, and for meaningful participation of affected communities (launch). A media rights organisation published its own analysis of the strategy's governance gaps in June 2026, the base's clearest instance of non-governmental scrutiny after the fact rather than participation before it (analysis).	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	A cyber security and monitoring of interception centre sits as a unit in the Office of the President, and a national truth-verification platform is proposed, layered on a false-data-message offence. The centre was established by the Cyber and Data Protection Act, which amends the interception statute to create it; the Act's long title and the reporting organisation's account name the body differently (centre , Act). The truth-verification platform is proposed in the artificial-intelligence strategy and is layered on the false-data-message offence and that monitoring centre (platform). A state truth-verification platform proposed on top of an existing false-information offence and an interception unit in the presidency is the combination, and the strategy that proposes it has no legal force.	REGRESSED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	Digital and information technology lines were appropriated in the 2026 Appropriation Act, and no revised, released or actual figure is held. These are original appropriations only, carried in local currency with no dollar equivalent stated (appropriation , second , revenue). A citizens budget was published for the 2025 financial year (citizens), and a parliamentary budget office was assessed in an external open budget survey round rather than by government (office). Original appropriations with no outturn, in a unit whose universal services fund publishes no balance either, is the whole of the domestic financing record.	ADVANCED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A cross-border fibre public-private partnership switched on its first phase, and aviation and border-security digitisation talks were held at State House. The partnership is an equal-investment arrangement with the state operator retaining operational control (partnership , highway). The border-security talks produced no instrument, value, scope or data-protection provision for systems that would process traveller data (talks). A state operator keeping operational control in an equal-investment partnership is an unusual structure in this frame and is recorded as such.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	A scheme of reconstruction transferred passive infrastructure into a new company that listed on the foreign-currency exchange, while the parent delisted voluntarily citing a valuation discount. The reconstruction completed in December 2025, with assets registered elsewhere held as nominee or in trust (reconstruction , circular). The infrastructure company listed by introduction on the foreign-currency exchange in March 2026 (listing , completion , statement). The parent's board resolved voluntary delisting in December 2025, citing a valuation discount against African peers (delisting). A syndicated vendor loan channelled US\$300m of a US\$500m group facility to the national operator in 2015, held as two records whose commitments cannot both be added (loan).	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A United Nations contract for ICT equipment was awarded in August 2026, and a regional science and technology accelerator is at expressions-of-interest stage. The equipment record is a contract-award notice, so the amount is exact and the purpose is only "ICT equipment" — what it equips, and for whom, is not established (contract , record). The accelerator's fund is resourced and the delivery consortium is not chosen, with no national allocation stated (accelerator). A youth digital skills programme carries a SEK 36,000,000 commitment from 2023, converted in the record at a stated rate (skills).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	Fifth-generation base stations rose on first-quarter 2026 sector data, and the state mobile operator's turnaround plan restated a US\$1bn-by-2029 target weeks before its chief executive was terminated. The base-station and rural-coverage figures are the regulator's own (stations , report , comparison). The turnaround target was restated at an annual general meeting; revenue figures are operator-reported and the same source states two growth rates that cannot both be right, and the chief executive's contract was terminated in August 2026 (plan , termination). Base stations deployed by the infrastructure company are company-reported for the quarter to May 2026 (deployment , and a broadband mapping programme is working with operators to identify poor-coverage areas (mapping).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	Internet penetration is active subscriptions divided by population rather than users, against a private tracker measuring 38.4 per cent of individuals, and wireless became the majority fixed technology. The regulator's rate divides active subscriptions by population and is not a measure of individual use (penetration , roadmap). Wireless became the majority fixed-broadband technology during the third quarter of 2025 (mix , and internet and data traffic rose on first-quarter 2026 figures given at a post-Cabinet briefing (traffic). A preferential buyer's credit for fixed broadband expansion ended in 2019; its title states US\$98.6m and its deal record carries US\$110,675,991, with no conversion basis on either (credit).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	An uncapped 500 Mbps fibre package at US\$99 came out of a price war, while satellite subscriptions grew against a rural population 76 per cent of whom live below the poverty line. The package prices are the operators' own, quoted in United States dollars (package , wireless). Satellite subscriptions grew in scale only; affordability is unchanged against a rural population three-quarters of whom live below the poverty line (affordability , silence). A media institute's review of internet affordability against income was published in August 2026 on regulator data; it is a review rather than a household survey, and the penetration figure it uses counts active subscriptions (review).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	Two ministerial fibre-length figures four months apart reconcile neither with each other nor with the regulator's series, and a cross-border corridor carries traffic on phase one. Two ministerial figures four months apart and a regulator series that matches neither is the measurement position (length , report). The corridor's first phase runs on an indefeasible right-of-use model with the state operator retaining operational control (corridor , switch-on). Government arrears owed to the state fixed operator doubled on the chief executive's statement at an annual general meeting; the two currency figures are the company's own (arrears) — the state is the largest debtor of the operator carrying its backbone.	MIXED a cross-border corridor switched on while ministerial fibre-length figures do not reconcile with each other or the regulator

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	Equipped international bandwidth rose on the regulator's fourth-quarter 2025 report, and the apparent collapse in headline used bandwidth is a reclassification rather than a fall in traffic. The measure excludes the satellite operator from the second quarter of 2025 (bandwidth). The satellite operator was excluded and the baseline restated from that quarter, so the apparent collapse in headline used bandwidth is a reclassification and not a fall in traffic (framework , report). Naming a measurement change as a measurement change is what stops a series break being read as a collapse. A terrestrial segment of a trans-continental cable, built by a domestically owned group, is stated ready for service in 2027 (segment).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	A national internet exchange point was reported to an international development forum in October 2020, and no traffic, peering or membership figure later than that is held. The report was made in October 2020 (exchange). Six years without a traffic, peering or membership figure is the record. It matters against the international-bandwidth series, because domestic peering is what would keep local traffic off that link.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite service launched in September 2024 after a cut-off order, two licences were issued with no coverage obligation or duration stated, and terminal subscriptions are counted as a category rather than by operator. The service launched in September 2024 after the 2024 cut-off order, and licence terms, fee and duration are not held (service , rural). Two licences were issued in September 2024 and announced four days later; no coverage obligation, duration or universal-service term is stated in the held account (licences , award). The regulator counts satellite terminals as a category and not the operator separately (terminals), and the country's share of the African satellite market is reported off that same series (share); the state fixed operator's own satellite reseller revenue is reported in its 2025 annual report (reseller).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	An operator commissioned a 5 MW facility in June 2025, which alone exceeds the about 2 to 2.5 MW analysts put on the whole commercial estate three weeks later. An operator commissioned a 5 MW data centre in Harare with a continental data-centre operator and began onboarding corporate clients at the end of June 2025, selling it on guaranteed power availability against load shedding and stating an intention to double it to 10 MW (facility). The market estimates were commissioned by a European facility and the brief gives both about 2 MW and about 2.5 MW for the national live load (capacity). One commissioned facility of 5 MW and a national estate of 2 MW measured three weeks apart cannot both be right, and nothing on file reconciles them. The technology park's groundbreaking is expected in the fourth quarter of the financial year, with capacity, cost and completion date unstated throughout (park , approval , ai-ready). The state operator's facility is described as a tier-three environment on its own undated product page, not certified or dated (state facility).	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	A national high-performance computing centre took a CNY 100,000,000 phase-two grant in 2017 to raise capacity from 36 to over 300 teraflops, and no delivered figure is held. Phase two was signed in December 2017 for implementation from 2018 (centre , grant), after a phase-one interest-free loan that ended in 2015 (phase one). Both records carry dollar equivalents with no conversion date stated. A university high-performance computer is operating with access quoted in large blocks rather than pay-as-you-go, developer-reported through one outlet rather than by the institution (university). Nine years on from the capacity target, no delivered figure exists.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	A geographically separated disaster recovery site is a stated Treasury priority, and two recovery sites for the procurement system went to tender in March 2026. Treasury's 2027 budget strategy paper sets a three-pronged approach to national ICT infrastructure: upgrading the national data centre to Tier IV standards, establishing a geographically separated disaster recovery site, and expanding the smart government private cloud for consolidation across ministries (strategy paper). No site, cost or timetable is stated. The procurement authority published notice PRAZ/RB/05/2026 on 18 March 2026 for two disaster recovery sites for the national electronic government procurement system, on international competitive bidding funded from its own budget, with contract signing scheduled for 31 March 2026 and an award notice for 4 June 2026 (notice). No award, and no operating off-site backup for any national system, is on the base.	ADVANCED
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	Phase one of a 100 MW solar farm for the technology park began construction in the quarter to May 2026, on company-reported figures. The construction start is company-reported (solar farm , update). A generation licence was issued to the mobile operator in March 2018; the capacity of the power arm now inside the infrastructure company is not held (licence). Building generation for a data centre whose own capacity, cost and completion date are unstated is the sequence, and both halves are the company's own account.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability	Solar systems were deployed across new and existing tower sites, artificial-intelligence fuel management entered phased rollout, and 1,044 health facilities were solarised across all ten provinces. The tower solar deployment and the fuel-management rollout are both company-reported for the quarter to May 2026, and the fuel-management gain is unquantified (solar , fuel). The health solarisation figures are the health financing partner's own, covering 1,044 facilities across all ten provinces (health). Solarising every province's health facilities while the satellite kits at rural health facilities sit unactivated for want of subscription payments is the contrast worth stating: the power arrived and the connectivity did not.	ADVANCED
Energy	Rural electrification	Rural electricity access stands at 8 per cent against 67 per cent urban, and the energy minister has directed that every school and rural health centre be electrified by the end of 2026. The 2023-24 demographic and health survey puts access to electricity at 8 per cent of the rural population against 67 per cent in urban areas (survey). The 2025 round of switch-on ceremonies closed on 31 October across eight rural provinces, with grid extension commissioned at sites in Binga, Insiza, Marondera, Muzarabani, Shurugwi, Gutu, Nyanga and Kariba districts reaching business centres, clinics and schools; the energy minister directed the agency to electrify every school and rural health centre in the country by the end of 2026 (ceremonies). A 120 kW solar mini-grid was commissioned in Hurungwe district on 21 May 2026 by the rural electrification agency under the rural electrification fund with United Nations development support (mini-grid). No count of connections made in the year is published, so the end-2026 direction cannot be measured against progress towards it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	A new tax platform was delivered in 2025, and the auditor-general found twelve ministries and commissions with no disaster recovery plans and payments running outside the system of record. The auditor-general reported that twelve ministries and commissions conducted no risk assessments for 2023 and had no disaster recovery plans in place, and that a number of fund accounts processed transactions outside the Public Finance Management System on manual systems, compromising internal controls and leaving some expenditure out of reported figures (audit). Government completed deployment of a new online tax and revenue management system, formally launched on 18 August 2025 with African Development Bank support (launch). The central bank's real-time gross settlement system was down from 18 to 19 August 2025 on what was described as a technical challenge, disrupting most banking systems (outage). No uptime, incident or recovery-time figure is published for any government platform.	MIXED a revenue platform delivered while the audit found no recovery plans and the settlement system went down
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	A government internet service provider has run government connectivity since 1998, and a locally built citizen platform was launched by the President in June 2026. The government internet service provider, operational since 1998 and mandated by a 2011 communique as the sole supplier to ministries, departments and parastatals, also offers hosting, web development, maintenance and content-management training (provider). The page carries no revision date and no staffing or capacity figure. An artificial-intelligence platform through which citizens rate and flag local-authority service delivery was launched by the President on 18 June 2026, built by a Zimbabwean startup incubated at a state technology institute (platform). A private operator signed a memorandum with government on 28 May 2026 to establish and run a software developer skills development hub, aligned by the parties to the master plan, the artificial-intelligence strategy and the ICT policy (memorandum). Against that, the audit record shows the capacity is uneven: recovery planning and use of the financial system of record both failed in 2023.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The national cybersecurity strategy was announced complete in October 2025 and described by the same minister as being finalised in July 2026; no text is held at either date. The ICT ministry announced on 15 October 2025 that the National Cybersecurity Strategy had been completed, presented as the overarching framework for protecting national digital assets (announcement). Nine months later the same minister said the ministry is finalising a National Cybersecurity Strategy for 2026-2030, anchored on a proposed national cybersecurity authority that would coordinate incident response and protect critical information infrastructure (July 2026). Both accounts are the minister's own, and no strategy document is held at either date. A national computer incident response team project is recorded with the International Telecommunication Union as implementing agency (project). An artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity fusion centre is proposed for real-time threat detection and remains proposed. The central bank has flagged vulnerabilities in third-party payment providers.	MIXED a strategy announced complete in 2025 and described as still being finalised in 2026, against an incident response capability that has moved

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TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	A whole-of-government enterprise resource planning system was launched as the precondition for clean public-sector data, and open interface standards are a ministerial commitment rather than a published standard. The system was built by a domestic supplier and launched in July 2026; deployment coverage is not stated, and the ministry presents it as the precondition for clean public-sector data (system). Mandated open interface standards for public-sector platforms are committed in the minister's five-point policy compass — a ministerial commitment, not a published standard (standards). Government information technology specification standards reached version 2.0 in May 2025, issued by the Office of the President and Cabinet's technology unit rather than the ICT ministry (specifications , version).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The national identity number is the search key in the collateral registry, and mobile money operators must validate subscribers against the civil registry from June 2026. The central bank's collateral registry is searchable for individuals by national identification number, or passport for non-nationals, and for institutions by business registration, business partner or licence number (manual). The 2026 monetary policy statement requires mobile money operators to run real-time validation of national identity numbers against the civil registry inside multi-layered know-your-customer frameworks, with biometric matching, a compliance deadline of 30 June 2026, and mandatory deregistration of unverified lines and accounts; the governor said validation is already in place and the bank is working towards full civil registry integration (directive). A 2026 constitutional amendment assigns the registrar-general voter registration and custody of the voters' roll, putting electoral identity under the same authority (amendment). Nothing on the base reports what happened at the June deadline, and no count of validated accounts is published.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	A health information exchange has a core implementation guide held as a continuous-build draft marked for demonstration and practice purposes only. The guide is the health ministry's own continuous build at version 0.1.0, marked "content is for demonstration and practice purposes only"; the underlying exchange is reported by the financing partner rather than by the ministry (guide , case study). A published interoperability specification carrying its own disclaimer that it is not for production use is a precise statement of where health interoperability stands here.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	A dropout early-warning system now runs off the education management information system, and a school-registration system with EMIS integration went to consultancy in April 2026. A 2019 peer review of the education management information system found education data submitted to the statistics agency but no formal structures for data sharing among key stakeholders, and recommended stronger inter-ministerial linkages and a data reporting and sharing calendar (review). An early warning system integrated with the education system now generates real-time lists of learners at risk of leaving school; the 2025 data behind it showed almost 40,000 learners dropped out that year (early warning). A web-based school-registration information management system with satellite-school tracking and explicit integration to the education system went out as a five-month national consultancy on 16 April 2026, closing on 28 April (consultancy). Both moves are integrations inside the education sector; the base holds no exchange between education systems and any other government register.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	The social registry has a funded component for integration with the civil registry and other government data systems, and first-phase enumeration is complete. The first phase of enumeration for the social registry was completed in Mangwe district in December 2025 and extends to Nkayi and Mudzi, aiming at about 2 per cent of the population, roughly 80,000 households (project document). The survey was launched publicly in Nkayi district in March 2026 (launch). A proposed second phase would enumerate at least a further 4 per cent, about 160,000 households, with US\$1.7m for enumeration and US\$300,000 for IT and capacity building, the latter naming integration with civil registry systems and other government and partner data systems, platform upgrading and server hosting (project document). The registrar-general's own interoperability roadmap names social-benefit enrolment as a downstream trigger from birth registration (presentation). No integration is yet in operation: the interoperability is funded and described, not delivered.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A national digital identity was announced in May 2025 for a July 2025 start with no start recorded, and every claim about it in the base is relayed second-hand. No start is recorded and every claim is second-hand (identity , denial). Population registry modernisation began around 2023; the registrar-general states personnel are trained and materials in place, and no independent confirmation is held (modernisation). A digital identity announced fifteen months ago for a start that never happened, evidenced only at second hand, is the position — in a unit that has a licensing regime for data controllers and a certification fee for their officers.	STALLED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	A 2022 mobile civil registration exercise issued 3,203,389 documents, and the home affairs minister said he was not aware of any identity-document backlog and was hearing of it for the first time. The 2022 exercise ran February to September and was reported to Parliament by the home affairs minister (exercise). The backlog measure is set against that minister's denial in the Senate; he said he was not aware of any backlog and was hearing of it for the first time (backlog). A donor-funded mobile registration drive ran for five days in a remote district in July 2025 with no count of documents issued held (drive), and birth registration coverage is dated to the 2023-24 demographic and health survey rather than to the articles reporting it (coverage).	MIXED three million documents issued in a 2022 mobile exercise while the responsible minister says he is unaware of any backlog

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	Electronic passport enrolment runs in ten districts, eight provincial centres and one abroad, and civil registration office computerisation bounds a decentralisation model three other states said they would copy. The passport figures were stated by a deputy registrar general at a registrars' meeting (passport). The sub-office computerisation ratio bounds the decentralisation model three other states said they would copy, which is what makes the ratio worth stating (computerisation). A donor-funded programme to digitise and solarise civil registry sub-offices launched in August 2026 with no value, timetable, district list or birth-registration baseline against which to measure its effect (sub-offices , digitisation).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	Identity rests on the National Registration Act; a nationwide handover in August 2026 puts voter registration under the same authority and sub-offices are being computerised. The National Registration Act, consolidated to 31 December 2016, is the statute under which the register of residents and the issue of identity documents sit (Act). The civil registry department and the electoral commission began a nationwide joint transfer of voter registration and voters' roll management to the registrar-general on 18 August 2026, provincial and district officers of both bodies meeting in Harare to operationalise it (handover). The home affairs ministry announced in October 2025 that civil registry sub-offices would be computerised countrywide to safeguard citizens' records; ten sub-offices across eight districts are now being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded, UNICEF-managed project (announcement , project). No authentication service, credential or transaction count is published, and the national digital identity itself remains announced and unlaunched.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	Birth registration stands at 57 per cent, and ten rural sub-offices are being computerised to widen access to registration at the point of birth. The Births and Deaths Registration Act, in force as amended to 6 March 2020, requires registration of births, still-births and deaths (Act). Birth registration coverage stands at 57 per cent, with no later national figure held (coverage). Ten decentralised civil registry sub-offices across eight districts are being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded, UNICEF-managed project, aimed at children and families in remote communities who need legal identity documents to reach health, education and social protection (project). A provincial registry office commissioned in Mutare in September 2025 for biometric passport and identity services was described by the registrar-general as foundational to a digital identity system (registry office). There is no identity credential issued at birth: registration produces a paper certificate, and the identity document comes later.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	A secure exchange platform for birth and death notifications is in build, with automated validation against the national population register and a pilot set for 2027. The registrar-general's ICT deputy told the regional registrars' meeting on 18 July 2026 that Zimbabwe is still in the implementation phase, with a secure interoperability platform being built to exchange birth and death notifications between health facilities and the civil registry (presentation). The same account names automated validation and synchronisation against the national population register as the mechanism for minimising duplicate records, and sets a roadmap of a business intelligence module in the third quarter of 2026, middleware design in the fourth, training through 2026 and 2027, and a three-province pilot in the first half of 2027 (roadmap). Registry modernisation itself remains under way with no completion date and no coverage figure. Nothing interoperable is yet in service: what the base holds is a design, a roadmap and an acknowledged gap.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	A cotton farmer biometric registry was cleared to proceed on the model of a tobacco farmer identity registry for which the base holds no primary. The marketing authority was cleared to proceed with field teams stated for October 2025; that date is the acting chief executive's stated intention rather than a confirmed start (cotton). The tobacco registry is cited as the model the cotton registry emulates, and the base holds no primary from the marketing board – only a secondary reference (tobacco). Biometric registration of farmers by commodity marketing boards, modelled on a system nobody has published anything about, in a country with no working national digital identity. A third farmer registry, run by a United Nations agency rather than a ministry, entered a second phase in October 2025 targeting 36,588 farmers across 12 districts in four provinces for the 2025/26 cropping season, with 14,915 registered by 30 October and completion expected in the first week of November (farmer registry). Three separate farmer registries on three separate applications is the pattern worth naming: each is built for the programme that funded it.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank established a digital transformation and financial technology department with a sandbox and an innovation hub, and publishes a quarterly national payment systems report. The department was announced by a deputy governor at a technology forum; no separate central bank document is held (department , forum). The payment systems report is a first-party quarterly series; the first-quarter 2026 issue is not held, and the quarter-on-quarter comparison carried here is the second-quarter report's own (report , prior). Mobile money and interbank transfer limits were raised in the 2026 monetary policy statement, the bank stating the rise is intended to widen local-currency usage (limits).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	An integrated payroll and pensions system is operational in over 60 ministries, and the social security authority pays pensions into mobile money wallets. GovPay replaces a payroll platform of thirty-two years and covers every government employee and pensioner drawing from the Consolidated Revenue Fund; electronic payslips go to government electronic mail, a portal carries payslips, leave balances, loans and service records, and the system is operational in over 60 ministries and grant-aided institutions (newsflash). Its named integration partners are the revenue authority, banks, the social security authority, the government internet service provider and the telecommunications regulator, where the platform it replaces could not communicate with any of them (newsflash). The state social security authority says pensions can be paid straight into a mobile money wallet (pensions). No disbursement value, recipient count or take-up rate is held for either channel, and whether the full GovPay launch happened inside its stated 2026 target is not on the base.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	Radio-frequency toll tag express lanes opened at two of 29 plazas, with nothing stated on retention, access or legal basis for the movement record the tags generate. The first plaza was handed over in July 2026 (tolls). Nothing is stated on retention, access or legal basis for the movement record the tags generate — a vehicle-location dataset created by a revenue measure, in a unit with a licensing regime for data controllers that this system's operator would fall under. A taxpayer registration self-service portal is readying a second phase of the wider revenue management system, integrating third-party stakeholders; that detail is paywalled beyond the free lede (portal).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	A digital capital-market venue was described as newly approved at the signing of a growth-capital memorandum, with no approval date for the venue itself stated. The memorandum is an intent instrument and no approval date for the venue is stated (venue). A capital-market venue described as approved, at an event about something else, with no approval date, is the whole of the record.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	The instant payment interchange has run cross-domain transfers since 2011 across 17 commercial banks, and interoperable code payments are in rollout on the switch operator's report. The interchange was established in 2011 by the payments association and the central bank against cash shortages, when non-cash payment ran on cash machines, terminals and cheques that took up to seven days to settle and mobile money did not yet exist in the country; it carries real-time credit-push transfers between bank accounts and mobile wallets across 17 commercial banks, person-to-person transfer remaining its most used case (case study). The code-payment rollout is company-reported (codes , transactions). Wallet cash-out onto bank machine estates has no launch dates in the source, so the analysis date is used (cash-out). Ten cash-recycler machines are installed at retail outlets with 78 stated in the pipeline; the figures are the reporting outlet's rather than company-audited (recyclers).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Electronic retail transaction value and volume rose in the first half of 2026 on figures in different currencies over different periods, and cards issued far exceed cards in use. The two transaction figures are in different currencies over different periods and are not directly comparable (transactions , growth). The cards figure is a survey quoted by the researcher with no base, sample or method published (cards), and national payment system value rose on June 2026 monthly figures, with the May volume derived from a reported fall rather than stated directly (system value). A national financial inclusion strategy runs 2022 to 2026, citing formally served adults rising from 69 per cent in 2014 to 83 per cent in 2022 against a 90 per cent target (inclusion).	MIXED electronic transaction value surging while cards issued far exceed cards in use

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Participation in the continental payment and settlement system is company-reported to a payments conference, and regional settlement onboarding is attributed to the operating central bank rather than to this one. The continental participation reaches the base through the switch operator's report to a conference (participation). The regional onboarding intent, cited as potentially by end-2027, is attributed to the operating central bank and nothing establishes a domestic decision (onboarding). Card acceptance was extended to nine African markets with merchant and card counts given as the two companies' own and no country-specific figure (cards).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	Bank charge caps were directed for compliance by March 2026, with a named analyst recording the governor conceding limited enforcement capacity. The caps were set in the February 2026 monetary policy statement (caps , consumer rights , legal tender). Online payment gateways are configured to settle in United States dollars first, so local currency is not accepted on them; that is named-analyst opinion, attributed (gateways). A price cap whose own setter concedes limited enforcement capacity, and a legal tender that online gateways will not take, are the two consumer findings this ledger supports.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Population register	The population register is being modernised and now takes automated validation from civil registration, with the voters' roll moving under the same authority. The register of residents sits under the National Registration Act as consolidated to 31 December 2016 (Act), and its modernisation has been under way since about 2023 with no completion date and no coverage figure held. The registrar-general's ICT deputy set out automated validation and synchronisation with the national population register as part of the civil registration and health integration under way, with a three-province pilot due in the first half of 2027 (presentation). From 18 August 2026 voter registration and the voters' roll are being transferred nationwide to the registrar-general, folding electoral identity into the same institution that holds the population register (handover). No registered-population count, update cycle or accuracy measure is published.	ADVANCED
Registries	Civil register	The civil register published a 2023-2024 vital statistics report, and computerisation now covers all ten provinces with ten rural sub-offices being equipped. The statistics agency and the civil registry department published a 79-page vital statistics report for 2023-2024, reporting registered births, deaths, marriages and other vital events by province, age and sex (report). All ten provinces and 63 districts are computerised, reported to a meeting of African registrars general in July 2026 (registrars). Ten decentralised sub-offices across eight districts are being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded, UNICEF-managed project, extending the register below district level for the first time on this base (project). The statute behind all of it is unchanged since 2020 (Act). No completeness or timeliness rate for death registration is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Address register	No address register is held. A national addressing system was named in the 2016 ICT policy as a matter for a postal sector policy, and named again in 2026 as a topic for expansion. The 2016 national ICT policy names a national address system among the matters a postal sector policy would need to cover, alongside market structure, post office infrastructure and universal service (policy). Ten years later the regulator's call for chapters for a book on the postal sector lists expanding the national addressing system as a topic, framed around last-mile accessibility and rural inclusion (call). Between the two the base holds nothing: no address register, no coverage figure, no implementing instrument, no operator and no postal sector policy. What both ends of the decade record is the same intention, restated.	NO CHANGE named in policy for a decade and never described
Registries	Business register	The deadline for re-registering onto the electronic registry was moved out two years in April 2026, from 20 April 2026 to 20 April 2028. The Companies and Other Business Entities Act constitutes the registration office under a chief registrar and defines the electronic registry and electronic records the register runs on (Act). Statutory Instrument 108 of 2025 set 20 April 2026 as the deadline for companies and private business corporations registered before the electronic registry to re-register, with automatic deregistration and removal from the register for those that did not (regulations). Three days before it fell due, Statutory Instrument 76 of 2026 deleted that date and substituted 20 April 2028 (amendment). No count of entities re-registered, or still to re-register, is published at either date. Separately, of 204,798 establishments surveyed, more than 76 per cent were found operating informally (establishments).	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Social protection register	The social registry completed first-phase enumeration in December 2025 and has a funded second phase aiming at a further 4 per cent of the population. The first phase of enumeration was completed in Mangwe district in December 2025 and extends to Nkayi and Mudzi, aiming at about 2 per cent of the population, roughly 80,000 households (project document). A proposed second phase would enumerate at least a further 4 per cent, about 160,000 households, with US\$1.7m for enumeration and US\$300,000 for IT and capacity building (project document). Field collection began publicly in Nkayi district in March 2026, gathering demographics, education, employment, housing, land ownership, access to services and economic activity (launch , survey). No enrolled-household count, hosting arrangement or completion date is held, and the registry has not yet carried a live targeting decision.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register	A third constitutional amendment on the voters roll has begun implementation, transferring the roll to the registrar-general – the office that determines identity and vital status would also determine the electorate. The justice minister told the Senate implementation had begun, with remaining work described as administrative rather than legislative (amendment , transfer). The office that determines identity and vital status would also determine the electorate. That is the finding, and the ledger states it directly rather than leaving it to inference. It lands in a unit where the responsible minister says he is unaware of any identity-document backlog and where the national digital identity has never started.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Tax register	The tax register runs on a platform fully implemented in 2024; a new statutory registration category took effect in January 2026 and a compulsory master data update closed in April. The revenue authority's tax and revenue management system reached full implementation with a fifth-module release on 1 October 2024, adding case management, debt management, investigations and audit and risk and compliance, with taxpayer-facing services through a self-service portal (notice); a second phase integrating third-party stakeholders is being readied. The Finance Act 2025 inserted a new Part IIIB into the Income Tax Act with effect from 1 January 2026, creating a compulsory registration category of registrable proprietors, the owners, lessees and sub-lessees of premises let to tenants liable for presumptive tax (Act). Every taxpayer was required to confirm and correct the names, contacts and business classifications held for them by 30 April 2026 (update). No registered-taxpayer count is published at any date, so neither the statutory expansion nor the cleanse can be measured.	ADVANCED
Registries	Land register	A live cadastre portal carries property search and cadastral services, and a two-week validation pilot with sixteen law firms ended with no result on file. The cadastre portal is live, carrying property search, electronic maps, cadastral and geodetic services and account registration, with surveyor modules behind a requested profile; the page carries no date of its own (portal). The instrument text on securitised deeds is not held; all three accounts of it are law-firm-authored and one firm has a commercial interest in validation volume (instrument , guide , discussion). The pilot ran two weeks in April 2026 and is reported by one of the sixteen selected firms, with no result on file (pilot). Naming the commercial interest of the only sources describing a deeds-validation regime is what a reader needs to weigh them. A public portal exists; what it has issued does not.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Health	1,254 of a planned 1,900 facilities run the national electronic medical record, and one province reports 90.2 per cent infrastructure coverage with a fifth of its sites not yet functional. The facility figure is reported by the financing partner, and the platform's own page carries no publication or last-updated date (record , platform). A provincial evaluation puts 90.2 per cent of that province's 153 facilities across seven districts on the record infrastructure with 110 sites fully functional, a functionality gap of 18.3 percentage points, and reports another province at 88 per cent coverage and 68 per cent functional (evaluation). The same evaluation records 15 facilities excluded from the rollout altogether — mine clinics, border posts and uniformed-forces facilities (evaluation). Coverage is the number reported nationally; functionality is the number only one province has measured. The health strategy's term ended in 2017 with no successor strategy held (strategy). An operator opened a virtual telemedicine hospital in one province, company-reported with no patient, consultation or availability figure (telehealth).	MIXED national coverage unchanged and one province measured for the first time

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Education	The education management information system now drives a dropout early-warning module, and a school-registration system went to consultancy in April 2026. An early warning system integrated with the education management information system generates real-time lists of learners at risk of leaving school; the 2025 data behind it showed almost 40,000 learners dropped out that year, and government has begun a programme to find and re-enrol them (early warning). A web-based school-registration information management system, with satellite-school tracking and integration to the education system, went out as a five-month national consultancy on 16 April 2026 (consultancy). A 2019 peer review is still the base's only assessment of the system's quality, and it found no formal structures for data sharing among key stakeholders (review). No enrolment, coverage or data-quality figure from the system itself is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The social registry is being built to identify households qualifying for assistance, with a stated rollout across all 65 districts. The responsible minister described the registry as a database to identify households qualifying for social assistance, to be used in selecting beneficiaries of the basic education assistance module and taken to all 65 districts of the country to reduce duplication and double-dipping (minister). Enumeration is the constraint. The first phase completed in Mangwe district in December 2025 and extends to Nkayi and Mudzi, aiming at about 2 per cent of the population (project document). Enumerators collect demographics, education, employment, housing, land ownership, access to services and economic activity (survey). Nothing in the base states how many households are enrolled, where the system is hosted, or when it is expected to carry a live targeting decision.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	All superior courts are paperless under the electronic case management system, and the magistrates' courts rollout reached its fourth phase in 2026. The chief justice told the opening of the 2026 legal year that all superior courts are paperless under the Integrated Electronic Case Management System and that four magisterial provinces had been digitised under its fourth phase, with Manicaland and Mashonaland East to be prepared next (address). Sixteen magistrates' courts in Masvingo and Matabeleland South went live under phase 4.2 from October 2025, and the system reached the rural districts of Chipinge and Chimanimani on 13 January 2026 (phase 4.2 , rural districts). Sixteen further magistrates' courts in Manicaland and Mashonaland East were set for digitisation under phase 4.3 from 1 June 2026 (phase 4.3). Policing is the part of the justice chain that has not moved: an electronic docket system announced in December 2025 still carries no timetable, cost or supplier. No case volume or disposal-time figure from the court system is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	The revenue system reached full implementation in October 2024, and fiscalised transaction recording was extended to fuel in May 2026. The tax and revenue management system reached full implementation with a five-module release on 1 October 2024, adding revenue forecasting, case management, extended debt management, investigations and audit, and risk management and compliance, with taxpayer-facing services through a self-service portal (notice). It is integrated with the fiscalisation device management system, and a second phase integrating third-party stakeholders is being readied (system). Statutory Instrument 88 of 2026 extends fiscalised recording into fuel, requiring registration and providing for the procurement, approval and licensing of fuel fiscal device suppliers and developers (regulations). No transaction volume, revenue attribution or system availability figure is published for any of it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	An online border management system has been in phased rollout since January 2025 after 2024 pilots, and its transfer to another state runs on a bilateral memorandum rather than a continental standard. The rollout has been phased from January 2025 following biometric border-post pilots in 2024 (system , pilots). The transfer to another state runs on a 2024 bilateral memorandum and study visits, not a continental standard — which makes this an export of a system rather than adoption of one.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Land	Two land systems moved in 2026: a nationwide title deeds validation programme from May, and three agricultural land databases consolidated into one digital system by August. A nationwide title deeds validation and securitisation programme launched on 4 May 2026 under Statutory Instrument 76 of 2025, verifying existing property records for authenticity and converting them into securitised, digitally backed documents, with conveyancers submitting verification requests to the deeds registry (programme). It runs on a live digital land administration platform carrying property search, electronic maps and cadastral data (platform). On the agricultural track the lands minister said three databases had been consolidated into one integrated digital system reached through a One Stop Title Processing Centre, with 27,045 plots surveyed and 10,231 mapped to beneficiaries at 24 August 2026 and 1,824 agreements of sale worth about US\$110m concluded (land tenure). Those figures are the implementation committee's own, and no count of deeds validated under the deeds registry track is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	An electronic procurement system operational since January 2024 has added chatbots and machine-assisted bid evaluation, and there is still no national services portal in this ledger. The procurement system was launched in October 2023 and became operational on 1 January 2024 for all public entities and bidders; the regulator says it has since added chatbots and virtual assistants and bid evaluation assisted by artificial intelligence, with no volume, saving or accuracy figure attached (procurement). The denominator of local authorities is not given in the record held, so the share filing on time cannot be stated (filing). The parliamentary programme is a first-hand account by the implementing partner with no national participant count (programme). There is still no national services portal, service count or government online-service measure anywhere in this ledger, which is itself the finding for a unit of this size: the state has automated the buying and not the serving.	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	22 of 92 local authorities fully use an enterprise resource planning system and 65 partially, and one rural council is digitising every operation by December 2026. The local government minister reported 22 local authorities fully using an enterprise resource planning system and 65 partially, against 92 authorities in the country (briefing). Manyame Rural District Council is migrating billing, payments, records management, land and housing administration, permitting and resident communication onto one platform in a US\$491,039 programme funded from its own budget, begun in December 2025 and targeted for December 2026 (council). Connectivity is arriving separately: 205 digital information centres stood nationwide at 4 June 2026, the newest commissioned at Nemamwa in Masvingo province (centres). Only one council's revenue system is described in the base in any detail, and no later national count of enterprise-system use than the 2024 figure is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	One council's own page states its billing runs on an enterprise resource planning package, not established as representative, and 250 satellite kits were handed to the local government ministry with deployment falling to councils. The closing position is one council's own statement and is not established as representative; no national follow-up audit of local-authority automation is held (council , audit). The reporting outlet notes deployment, maintenance and security of the satellite kits fall to councils, and no follow-up source is held (kits). Kits handed to a ministry with the running costs pushed to councils is the same pattern the rural health facilities show, where the subscriptions were never paid.	NO CHANGE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	Satellite kits at rural health facilities are not activated because subscriptions are unpaid, on the health minister's own statement to the National Assembly. The minister told the National Assembly the subscriptions are unpaid (facilities). The donation programme handed out kits with no cumulative total published by government, and the health minister's account is that they are not activated (kits , donation , record). Hardware distributed and left unconnected for want of a subscription line is the sharpest delivery failure in this unit, and it is stated by the responsible minister in Parliament.	STALLED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	A school connectivity and solar programme targets every school connected by December 2026, on the minister's own counts with no school total or verification of working terminals stated. The counts and the target are the minister's own; no school total, verification of installed and working terminals, or recurrent connectivity cost is stated (programme). The recurrent cost is the point on which the rural health kits failed — hardware installed and subscriptions unpaid — and no source states who pays it for schools.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	More than 20 of 209 civil registry sub-offices are computerised, the same figure the base held a year earlier, with ten more being equipped. More than 20 registry offices and sub-offices had been computerised by July 2025, allowing real-time data entry and faster document processing; one fully computerised sub-office sits 200 metres from the maternity ward at a Bulawayo hospital, so mothers can register a newborn before discharge (programme). A year later the figure reported to a meeting of African registrars general was the same: all ten provinces and 63 districts computerised, but more than 20 of 209 sub-offices, under a tenth of the local layer (registrars). Ten further sub-offices across eight districts are now being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded, UNICEF-managed project (project). The sub-office layer is where rural registration happens, and it is the layer that did not move.	NO CHANGE the same count a year apart
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	The police carry an ICT directorate with officers in every province; nothing on the base describes a system at rural station level. The police ICT directorate sits at general headquarters under a director at commissioner rank with three assistant commissioners, and provincial ICT officers represent it in each police province, supported by ICT workshops, equipment stores and systems administration (structure). An electronic docket system to process every docket electronically was announced in December 2025 and has no timetable, cost or supplier on the base (docket system). Point-of-sale machines were announced in October 2025 for every police roadblock in the country, with satellite kits supplying connectivity, to make spot-fine payment traceable; no deployment count has followed (roadblocks). An electronic court system reached the rural districts of Chipinge and Chimanimani in January 2026, which is the adjacent justice interface rather than the police one (courts).	NO CHANGE a directorate described and no station-level system on the base

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	Cabinet approved the AI strategy in October 2025, a national challenge is running its delivery arm, and Parliament asked for AI-assisted tender adjudication. Cabinet approved the National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2026-2030 on 14 October 2025, the founding governmental act behind adoption in public administration (approval). A private member's motion moved in the National Assembly on 29 April 2026 asks the procurement regulator and the finance ministry to introduce artificial-intelligence assisted systems in government tender adjudication with human oversight, citing persistent allegations of corruption, delay and inconsistency; no instrument or pilot follows it (motion). The strategy's grand challenge is being delivered by the telecommunications regulator with the International Telecommunication Union, the ICT ministry and the high performance computing centre, over data, design, development and deployment tracks, with public service delivery named among its target sectors (challenge). No artificial-intelligence system is recorded in production in a government administrative process.	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Artificial-intelligence remote monitoring and a digital twin are described as advancing in a company trading update for the quarter ended May 2026. It is company-reported (monitoring). A digital twin of a tower estate is the most technically specific artificial-intelligence deployment claim in this unit, and it is a listed company's own trading-update language with no measure attached.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	An indigenous-language corpora programme is committed with universities to lead and part-financing from the universal services fund, and an artificial-intelligence literacy campaign is introduced in the strategy. The corpora programme is committed with universities leading and part-financed from the universal services fund (corpora). The literacy campaign is introduced in the strategy (campaign). Both draw on a fund whose balance is unpublished and whose Auditor-General report gives no disbursement figure, which is the constraint under every artificial-intelligence commitment in this unit.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	A nationwide expansion of artificial-intelligence traffic cameras was announced under a smart policing programme, and a separate municipal traffic system is rolling out across the capital's central business district amid entrapment concerns. The national rollout's supporting figure — an annual crash cost — is the transport ministry's, given in support of the rollout (national). The municipal system is distinct from the national police programme and is reported alongside entrapment concerns (municipal). An earlier capital traffic management system is reported in operation and described as developed by the state operator, with every claim in the source relayed second-hand (earlier). Three overlapping camera programmes, none with a stated retention rule or legal basis.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A locally built enterprise platform already running in 83 local authorities was commercially launched in July 2026, and a laptop assembled in Zimbabwe in May. A Zimbabwean-built enterprise platform was formally launched at a university technology expo in July 2026; its developer already carries systems across 83 local authorities and government projects including a mines export permit system, a service delivery standards platform and the citizen engagement platform, with stated plans to expand into Zambia, Botswana and Ethiopia (launch). A laptop assembled in Zimbabwe through a partnership between a private technology firm and an associate of the state fixed operator was launched in Harare on 14 May 2026; no production volume, unit price or order book is held (laptop). The standing diagnostic remains a United Nations assessment across seven policy areas, closing on an action matrix (assessment). The passive infrastructure the sector runs on went the other way: it was transferred as a going concern into a separately listed company in February 2026.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	Three hubs moved in 2026: a national information access centre in March, a university incubation centre in July, and a technology institute's expo in August. A national information access centre was commissioned in March 2026 at a state open university's Harare campus, through a partnership with South Korea's national information society agency (centre). The President commissioned a university industrial incubation centre in Msasa on 27 July 2026, giving technical support, mentorship and industrial collaboration to 11 start-up companies across agriculture, ICT, engineering, pharmaceuticals, health, transport and energy (incubation centre). A technology institute's innovation hub, carrying a technopreneurship development centre and a new centre for artificial intelligence, hosted a three-day expo from 28 to 30 July 2026 with an anticipated 10,000 participants (expo). The central bank's own innovation hub, announced in November 2025, still has no location, staffing or opening date on the base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A national artificial-intelligence innovation fund is named in the strategy and a separate catalyst fund was announced in August 2026, and the two are not stated to be the same vehicle. The strategy names one fund and a catalyst fund was announced at a grand challenge launch; the two are not stated to be the same vehicle (fund , catalyst , launch). A ring-fenced share of the universal services fund is committed for public-good artificial intelligence with no amount stated (ring-fenced). The central bank cites a regulatory sandbox as operating, pre-dating the window with no earlier position held (sandbox), and an innovation hub was announced as to be created under the new department (hub).	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A digital learning platform for civil servants was launched in early 2026, and training is to be made mandatory at 10,000 employees a year. The public service commission announced the launch of a digital learning platform for civil servants in its first-quarter 2026 newsletter, alongside leadership development, pension reform and results-based management training (newsletter). Digital skills training is to be made mandatory for all civil servants, with at least 10,000 public employees trained each year in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data management, announced at the 2026 budget pre-seminar under the science, technology and human capital reform cluster (announcement). The artificial-intelligence strategy launched in March 2026 gives public-sector skills a policy home (strategy). Neither the platform nor the mandatory scheme carries an enrolment, completion or start-date figure on the base, so the annual target has nothing to measure against.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	43.7 per cent of Zimbabweans hold basic digital skills on the 2025 household survey, the first national figure the base has held. The 2025 household ICT survey found 43.7 per cent of Zimbabweans holding basic digital skills, and separately that 31 per cent of internet users now use artificial-intelligence applications (survey). It is the base's first measurement, so it fixes a level rather than a direction. The named national programme is the 1.5 million coders initiative, whose registration portal and free modules in programming, artificial-intelligence basics, Android development and data science opened to the public in September 2025 (registrations). The ICT policy carries digital skills and rural training as priority areas (policy). No enrolment or completion count is published against the 1.5 million target, so the programme and the measurement cannot yet be read against each other.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	Coding in the secondary curriculum was directed at a national seminar on digital sovereignty, and a coding programme with a Gulf state rests on one excerpt source. The curriculum direction was given at a seminar in July 2026 (curriculum). The Gulf attribution rests on one excerpt source, and a July 2026 restatement of the target does not name the partner (programme). A curriculum change directed by ministerial statement, and a delivery partnership whose partner cannot be confirmed, is the school-level record.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	Twenty institutions are registered with the higher education regulator, and two industry-linked programmes delivered certified cohorts in 2025. Twenty higher education institutions were registered with the council for higher education at June 2024 — thirteen state universities and seven private institutions offering degrees — with their accredited programmes listed by institution (register). Forty students at a state technology university completed training in artificial intelligence, blockchain, internet of things and cloud computing with globally recognised certification, under a partnership supported by a United States embassy grant (graduation). Sixty-seven educators and staff from three southern African technology universities completed a twelve-hour programme on panoramic learning hardware and software under a UNESCO-led regional project, 96 per cent saying they would adopt simulation technology at their institutions (training). The regulator's register is held only as an excerpt truncated after the first institution, so the base cannot say how many of the accredited programmes are digital ones.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	An artificial-intelligence grand challenge launched in August 2026, and a digital skills programme targeting 1.5 million people is described as delivered with a Gulf state. The challenge's own account gives about 60 participants against 68 projects reported, which does not reconcile and is unestablished (challenge , progress , strategy). The 1.5 million target is described as delivered in partnership with a Gulf state (skills). More than 3,000 youths were trained under a government cybersecurity programme (cyber), and a digital skills ambassadors programme was named at the strategy launch (ambassadors).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	The research council's 2023 and 2024 annual reports both confirm no gross research and development expenditure figure is published. The absence is stated by the council's own annual reports, which is what makes it a finding rather than a gap in capture (2023 , 2024). No research and development expenditure figure, and no share of gross domestic product, exists for this country in either report. Against an artificial-intelligence strategy proposing four institutions and a corpora programme led by universities, the country's own research council publishes no measure of what it spends on research.	ADVANCED

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	409 free public wireless hotspots are deploying, and a digital centres programme is described as established nationwide offering free internet, equipment and literacy training. The hotspot figure is ministry-reported (hotspots). The digital centres are described as established nationwide with no count, location list or usage figure (centres , kits). A presidential internet scheme is cited as the channel for satellite access with no site count published, and its start date is padded to 2025 because the source says only "earlier this year" (scheme).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	A citizen scoring platform launched in June 2026 lets residents rate local-authority service delivery, and the AI strategy records a three-city consultation. An artificial-intelligence platform through which citizens rate and flag local-authority service delivery was launched by the President on 18 June 2026, built by a Zimbabwean startup incubated at a state technology institute (platform). The artificial-intelligence strategy names a national multi-stakeholder consultation held in Harare on 28 August 2025 and in Bulawayo and Masvingo on 9 and 11 September 2025, whose interrogation and validation of an earlier draft produced the final text (strategy). Parliament's own record shows the standing scrutiny machinery in operation, the legal committee reporting non-adverse certificates on the statutory instruments gazetted that month (record). No participation, submission or usage count is held for any of the three.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Gender equity	A national gender policy is in force and a digital skills hub for rural women was launched in October 2025; no gendered digital-access figure is held. The current national gender policy is grounded in sections 17 and 52(2) of the Constitution and names the Data Protection Act as the instrument addressing gender-based violence in digital spaces (policy). The women's affairs ministry launched a digital empowerment initiative in Harare in October 2025 to equip rural women with technology skills for agriculture, business and enterprise (hub). At the artificial-intelligence strategy's launch the United Nations resident coordinator called for gender-responsive and inclusive design and for diverse, high-quality datasets to confront bias and exclusion (launch). Where a gendered figure does exist it is in education rather than access: 152 of the 192 recipients of laptops under a technical and vocational bursary in July 2026 were women (laptops). No sex-disaggregated internet, device or skills figure is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	A Persons with Disabilities Act was passed in November 2025 and awaits commencement; two training programmes ran in 2026. The Act repeals the Disabled Persons Act and establishes a National Disability Affairs Board; its definition of communication expressly takes in Braille, tactile communication, large print, accessible multimedia and accessible information and communication technology, and it carries a universal design standard covering equipment, facilities, programmes and services (Act). It comes into operation on a date to be fixed by the President, and no commencement notice is held. Librarians from more than 22 state universities were trained on assistive technologies over two days in June 2026, the devices, software and inclusive furniture funded by a US\$220,000 grant secured by the university libraries consortium (workshop). The telecommunications regulator and a civil-society internet chapter trained 35 participants with disabilities from the Lupane, Dete and Binga districts in basic ICT skills (training). No figure for digital access or device ownership among persons with disabilities is published.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	A community radio station launched in the Tongogara refugee settlement in February 2026, reaching an estimated 25,000 to 40,000 listeners. A digital education partnership between the refugee agency and a foundation has run in four schools in Zimbabwe since 2022, benefiting 5,280 primary students and 109 teachers (partnership). No later figure is held. A community radio station broadcasting from the Tongogara refugee settlement launched in February 2026 and reaches an estimated 25,000 to 40,000 listeners including surrounding host communities (station). Before it, residents had limited access to timely information and poor radio reception. Laptops handed to the first cohort of a technical and vocational bursary programme in July 2026 went to 192 participants, the cohort including 13 refugees and 10 persons with disabilities (handover). All three are donor or partner programmes. Nothing on the base records a government policy or service that treats refugees and internally displaced people as a distinct group for digital access.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	The universal services fund is vested in the regulator as trustee with no balance or annual disbursement published in the Auditor-General's 2024 report, and its subscription support covers digital centres and schools only. Contribution rates are set by statutory instrument and the Auditor-General's 2024 report publishes no balance (levy , regulations , amendment , scope). Subscription support covers digital centres and schools, with a further unquantified share committed to artificial-intelligence projects (support) – which is the fund being asked to finance the artificial-intelligence strategy's institutions as well as connectivity. A tower relocation programme is funded from the same fund (towers), and rural network population coverage comes from the regulator's fourth-quarter 2025 report (coverage).	NO CHANGE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	The third statistics strategy ran to the end of 2025 and an orientation workshop for a fourth was held in May 2026; the fourth strategy is not held. The third strategy, covering 2021 to 2025, sets the framework for planning, budgeting and implementing statistical activities across the national statistical system, and carries an annex of thematic working groups mapped to ministries and agencies (strategy). An orientation workshop for the fourth strategy was held in May 2026, at which economists and financial-sector experts called for more investment in the national statistics systems, arguing reliable economic data is a precondition for investment and long-term planning (workshop). A data for development and innovation technical working group met in December 2025, the statistics agency's director-general saying the arrangement with United Nations agencies had reduced duplication and improved resource allocation (working group). The fourth strategy itself is not on the base, so what stands is a lapsed strategy and a preparation process.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	An ICT access and use survey released its 2025 round on 9,245 households at 91.3 per cent response, and only one outlet's account of it is held rather than the report. Only one outlet's account is held, not the report itself (survey). Household internet access rose and household computer ownership fell on that survey; the ownership measure is five years apart and the intervening trend is not held (access , ownership). A household budget survey ran a nationwide listing exercise in August 2026 with no stated field or release date (budget survey), and the regulator's quarterly sector report bears no date on its face, the held copy being a rehost with a proxy publication date (sector report).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The 2025 national accounts were compiled from surveys and administrative sources on a new base year, and civil registration is being wired to feed vital statistics. The national statistical system is defined in the Act as the producers, researchers and data providers of official statistics, its main producers the statistics agency and government ministries and departments, with the agency to coordinate and supervise it (system). The 2025 annual gross domestic product figures were released compiled from surveys and administrative sources with 2025 as the new base year, output at constant 2025 prices rising 8.29 per cent from ZWG 1,431.9 billion in 2024 to ZWG 1,550.5 billion in 2025 (release). The civil registration and health interoperability work is the clearest case of an administrative system being built to feed statistics, with automated validation against the national population register and a three-province pilot due in the first half of 2027 (presentation). The constraint is the statute: the agency itself said in October 2025 that the Act does not adequately support the efficient provision of official statistics.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data	The statistics agency runs a second version of its open data portal, while the strategy's own data platform and a data commons remain announcements. A second version of the statistics agency's open data portal is in use, with an openly published sustainable development goals portal launched on 9 July 2025 and an access and tutorial guide issued for it (guide). The guide mixes several dates and carries none of its own, and no dataset count, download figure or licence statement is held. The artificial-intelligence data platform is provided for in the strategy and is to be introduced gradually (platform , launch). The data commons was announced in August 2026 (commons). Neither announced instrument carries a dataset, custodian, licence or access rule. What is actually open is one agency's portal; what is promised is a platform and a commons under a strategy with no legal force.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A second phase of the earth observation programme launched in June 2025, its first phase having digitised over 300,000 farm parcel boundaries. The second phase launched in June 2025 with the agriculture ministry and African Development Bank finance, scaling satellite data into routine crop type mapping, drought and flood monitoring and farmer registry integration; the first phase produced the country's first nationwide winter wheat map in 2023 and a 2023/24 summer crop type map, and digitised over 300,000 farm parcel boundaries as the foundation of a prototype farmer registry (launch). The initiative took second runner-up as ICT innovator of the year at the 2025 national ICT excellence awards (award). A privately built Harare platform combines free five-day Sentinel-2 imagery, daily commercial high-resolution coverage and cloud-penetrating radar with weather models and artificial intelligence for farmers, insurers and financiers, and is piloting with partners in Malawi, Zambia and Tanzania (platform). Neither the public programme nor the private platform publishes an acreage, user or accuracy figure for what it is producing now.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	A national geospatial and earth-observation agency was established by general notice in 2019, constituted as a research institute. It was established by general notice in March 2019 (agency). No programme, dataset, budget or output is held for it at any date. Seven years of an earth-observation agency with nothing published about what it produces.	NO CHANGE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	The country withdrew from bilateral health cooperation talks citing sovereignty, and the two figures for the offer are unclosable because both are the same party's statements about an unsigned instrument. Withdrawal followed a presidential memo of December 2025; the model instruments were resolved in August 2026 and the gap between the two stated values is unclosable because both figures are the same party's statements about an unsigned offer (withdrawal , sovereignty , model , dispute , fact-check). A cloud partner experience centre opened at a summit; the facility is in a neighbouring country and the domestic interest is ownership rather than siting (centre). Two countries in this frame declined the same health arrangement over its data terms, which makes it a pattern rather than an incident.	STALLED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	The national data centre was launched in February 2021 under a US\$98m broadband initiative, vendor-led and export-credit financed, and city surveillance systems are mapped here with no domestic contract value or camera count held. The data centre's date and figure come from a peer-reviewed article rather than a government statement (centre). The surveillance mapping covers eleven countries and no domestic contract value or camera count is held (surveillance , smart city). An export credit facility of CNY 485,000,000 for mobile network expansion was committed in 2019 with a dollar equivalent carrying no conversion date (credit), and a forum in August 2026 discussed technology transfer critically, naming no project, transfer arrangement or commitment (forum).	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	The multiannual indicative programme for 2021-2027 carries no digital priority area, and no country-specific artificial-intelligence or adequacy instrument is held. The programme was adopted under a Commission implementing decision and has no digital priority area (programme). No domestic artificial-intelligence or adequacy instrument with the bloc is held at any date. The only European involvement in this ledger is a commissioned data-centre market brief and an accelerator at expressions-of-interest stage.	NO CHANGE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	An investment protection agreement with the United Arab Emirates is ratified and gazetted; a partnership agreement due by May 2026 was still unconcluded in August. The promotion and reciprocal protection of investments agreement with the United Arab Emirates was signed in June 2018, approved by the National Assembly on 29 September 2020 and the Senate on 1 October 2020, and ratified by the President on 28 November 2020 (instrument). The two governments agreed in Dubai in February 2026 to conclude a comprehensive economic partnership agreement within three months, its proposed scope agriculture, mining, energy and infrastructure (talks). Three months past that deadline the Emirati minister of state met the President in Harare on 10 August 2026 to discuss economy, investment and trade, and no agreement was announced (meeting). The digital commitment on the base remains unsupported: a coding programme is running with the Emirates against a 1.5 million target, and the base holds no signed memorandum, value, delivery partner or enrolment figure behind it.	MIXED a ratified investment treaty standing while a partnership agreement has run past the deadline its parties set

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	India and Zimbabwe reaffirmed reciprocal support for each other's Security Council bids in January 2026; no digital or data instrument is named between them. India has pledged to support Zimbabwe's bid for a non-permanent Security Council seat for the 2027-2028 term and Zimbabwe to back India's candidature for 2028-2029, reaffirmed at the Indian embassy's national day in Harare on 26 January 2026 and framed by both foreign ministries as south-south cooperation (reaffirmation). India's own bilateral brief records a defence cooperation memorandum signed during a Zimbabwean ministerial visit to Aero India 2025, alongside a joint commission agreement of 1987 and an air services agreement of 2014 (brief). Zimbabwe's foreign minister also named the International Solar Alliance and a readiness to expand collaboration in green energy and skills development (national day). No instrument on digital transformation, information technology or data is named in either account.	ADVANCED on diplomatic support rather than on any digital instrument

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Digital skills partnership agreement with the United Arab Emirates	The signed memorandum or programme document behind the 1.5 million coding programme; the base carries one excerpt source naming the partner and one later restatement of the target that does not, with no signing date, value, delivery partner or enrolment figure	2026-08-06
The 2025 household survey report	The statistics agency and regulator publication itself; the base holds only one outlet's account, so the sample design, provincial breakdowns and the rural and urban series behind the headline figures are that outlet's selection	2026-08-06
National electronic services portal	The address and service inventory of a citizen-facing government services portal; the base holds two sector portals and nothing that aggregates services	2026-08-06
National digital identity enrolment statistics	Any registrar-general or home affairs figure for cards issued or persons enrolled; the base establishes the announcement and the non-start, and holds no enrolment number at any date	2026-08-06
ICT Policy 2026-2030	The policy document, or a gazette notice or ministry release announcing it; the base carries only the statistics agency's director-general naming it on 2026-07-20 as a framework the household survey will inform	2026-08-06
Regulator's Q1 2026 sector performance report	The regulator's own quarterly report; the base holds the Q4 2025 report in full but carries Q1 2026 only through a news account of a post-Cabinet briefing, so the 379 base stations, the 19,000 km backbone and the 57.28% traffic rise are all secondary and no per-operator table exists to check them against	2026-08-06
National Cybersecurity Strategy document	The strategy itself; the base holds a one-minute report of the October 2025 launch and nothing else — no objectives, institutional arrangements, timetable or budget, and no subsequent milestone	2026-08-06

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